Lesson 3

Scoring Criteria & Strategies

Open response question types

Write About the Photo, Speak About the Photo, Read Then Write, Read Then Speak, Listen Then Speak, and Writing Sample are **open response questions**, and your answer will be evaluated by a grading engine. The grading engine is trained to understand your English proficiency just like expert human raters. Some of the aspects it evaluates include:

- the correctness of your grammar (grammatical accuracy)
- the variety and level of your grammar (grammatical complexity)
- the level of vocabulary used (lexical sophistication)
- the variety of word choice (lexical diversity)
- how well you answer the question that was asked (task relevance)
- how much you can say or write in a limited time (fluency)
- the pronunciation and pace of your speech (acoustic features; this one is for speaking questions only)

Source: DET Readiness Guide

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} **Grammar**

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Grammar

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Vocabulary

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- how well you answer the question that was asked (task relevance) → **Content of your answer**
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Speaking Course

Grammar

Tenses & Complex Sentences

Present Tenses

Tense	Examples	Usage
Present Simple	*I understand French, but I don't speak it very well.*	Used for state verbs in the present (not action verbs) e.g *love, like, belong*
	I study in the evenings.	A habitual action
	My best friend comes from India.	A fact or characteristic about someone or something
Present continuous	*I am studying English to pass the DET.*	An action taking place now or around the moment in time
	I am attending my graduation party next Friday.	A future action which has been arranged.
Present perfect simple	*I have been to India twice.*	An action that occurred at an unspecified moment in time.
Present perfect continuous	*I have been studying hard for the DET this week.*	An action that started in the past but is still happening now.

Past Tenses

Tense	Examples	Usage
Past Simple	*I <u>went</u> to California last year for vacation.*	An action completed at a specified time in the past.
Past continuous	*I <u>was studying</u> for the DET when my friend called me.*	An action in progress in the past that was interrupted.
Past perfect simple	*My friend <u>had arrived</u> before I finished my exam.*	Used when talking about 2 actions in the past. The first action uses had + verb, the second action uses Past Simple.
Past perfect continuous	*I <u>had been studying</u> for the DET for 3 weeks before I felt confident to take it.*	An ongoing or repeated action leading up to a particular moment in the past.

Future Tenses

Tense	Examples	Usage
Going to	*I have decided that I am going to take the DET next week.*	*A future intention or plan which was decided before.*
	I think I am going to get a good score on the DET.	A prediction based on evidence.
will	*Oh, I got a good score! I will celebrate tonight.*	A spontaneous decision made at the moment of speaking (not a plan)
Future continuous	*Next Monday morning, I will be taking my test so don't call me.*	An action in progress at a specific time in the future.
Future perfect simple	*By this time next week, I will have finished all my university exams!*	An action that will be completed before a specific time in the future.
Future Perfect continuous	*Next semester, I will be studying at my dream university.*	An ongoing action in the future but which has not begun yet.

Speaking Course

Grammar

The story was interesting. The story was unique. I enjoyed reading this book.

Speaking Course

Grammar

The story was interesting. The story was unique. I enjoyed reading this book.

Since the story was interesting and unique, I enjoyed reading it.

Speaking Course

Grammar

Adverb clause:

- Although I was busy, I always found time to read this book.
- A doctor saves lives while an athlete's job is only to entertain.

Speaking Course

Grammar

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Relative clause:

- The book was about zombies, which is a topic I'm fascinated about.
- Lucy, who is very a popular English teacher, is someone I admire a lot.

Speaking Course

Grammar

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Relative clause:

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Conditional sentences:

- If I get a good score on the DET, I will apply to a university in the US.
- If I owned a car, I would drive to work, but I don't so I take a bus.
- If I had studied harder in school, I would have passed all my exams.

Speaking Course

Vocabulary

Speaking Course

Synonyms

Common words	Synonyms	Common words	Synonyms
interesting	engaging, fascinating	famous	well-known, renowned
sad	depressed, miserable	fast	quick, swift
good	brilliant, impressive	slow	gradual
big	enormous, massive	help	assist, support
begin	initiate	idea	thought, concept
dangerous	hazardous, risky	important	necessary, Essential
explain	elaborate	show	demonstrate,
look	stare, gaze	dislike	despise, loathe, hate
many	abundant	beautiful	attractive, gorgeous
competitor	rival, opponent	useful	helpful, handy

Speaking Course

Phrasal Verbs

- To go over = to review or check something
- To come up with = to suggest or think of an idea
- To count on = to rely on someone or something
- To dress up = to dress in smart or formal clothes
- To get over = to stop feeling unhappy about something
- To keep up = to progress at the same rate as someone else
- To think over = to consider something carefully
- To stumble upon = To find something by accident
- To bump into = to meet someone by chance / accident
- To turn out = to happen in a certain way
- To pan out = to result or develop in a certain way
- To mull over = to think about something carefully
- To figure out = to find the solution
- To get on with = to start, or continue, doing something

Speaking Course

Task Relevance

Speaking Course

Fluency

Speaking Course

Pronunciation

Speaking Course

- Content words are stressed

words carrying the meaning	example
main verbs	SELL, GIVE, EMPLOY
nouns	CAR, MUSIC, MARY
adjectives	RED, BIG, INTERESTING
adverbs	QUICKLY, WHY, NEVER
negative auxiliaries	DON'T, AREN'T, CAN'T

Speaking Course

- Content words are stressed
- Function words are not stressed

words for correct grammar	example
pronouns	he, we, they
prepositions	on, at, into
articles	a, an, the
conjunctions	and, but, because
auxiliary verbs	do, be, have, can, must

Speaking Course

Talk about a challenge you encountered.

- What was the challenge?
- When and where was the challenge?
- How did you overcome it?

One of the **biggest challenges** I had to **overcome** in recent **years** was **improving** my **fitness**. I **spent** a few **years** not **playing sport** and not **eating** in a **healthy** way. I **put** on **more** than a few **pounds**, and I felt **tired running** and **exercising**.